



Euclase

△ **Single euclase crystal** from Chivor, Columbia, weighing 46.2 carats

Euclase is beryllium aluminium hydroxide silicate. It is generally white or colourless but can also be pale green or pale to deep blue – a colour for which it is particularly noted. It forms grooved prisms, often with complex end faces, and can also be found in masses and fibres. In faceted gems, pale to rich aquamarine is favourite, but other colours are also cut. It is relatively uncommon in gem material, and is principally cut for collectors. Euclase takes its name from the Greek *eu*, “good”, and *klasis*, “fracture”, in reference to the way in which it breaks in perfect planes.

Specification

Chemical name	Beryllium silicate	Formula	$\text{BeAlSiO}_4(\text{OH})$
Colours	Colourless, white, blue, green		
Structure	Monoclinic	Hardness	7.5
SG	3		
RI	1.65–1.67	Lustre	Vitreous
Streak	White		
Locations	Brazil, USA		



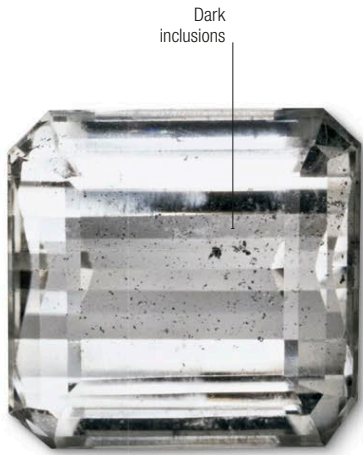
Pyramidal termination

Prismatic colourless euclase crystal | Rough | This single, perfectly formed euclase crystal displays a fine prismatic form. It is technically colourless, although it appears to have a yellowish tinge to its interior.



Blue crystal

Matrix specimen | Rough | Aside from being gem-quality, this blue euclase crystal, resting in a groundmass of quartz sprinkled with pyrite, is a fine specimen.



Dark inclusions

Octagonal gemstone | Cut | Full of dark inclusions yet a desirable stone, this colourless euclase is faceted in deep step-cut.



Brazilian stone | Cut | Featuring an emerald cut and a medium blue-green colour, this Brazilian stone originates from the Minas Gerais region.



Cushion-cut euclase | Cut | This cushion-cut gem also come from Brazil, and weighs 7.17 carats. It displays a greyish blue colouring.